

Pre-Settlement to Moving Day Checklist — ACT

The 30–90 day logistics, so nothing falls through the cracks.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal or financial advice.

Section 1 — Immediately After Signing

- ☐ [] **Confirm building insurance timing with your conveyancer.**
- ☐ [] **Send your signed contract to your lender/broker immediately.**
- ☐ [] **Diarise your cooling-off deadline** if it applies (5 business days for private treaty).
- ☐ [] **Engage your conveyancer formally** to begin searches and liaison with the seller's side.

Section 2 — 4–6 Weeks Before Settlement

- ☐ [] **Finalise unconditional loan approval.**
- ☐ [] **Get at least 3 removalist quotes** and book early.
- ☐ [] **Start decluttering and sourcing packing materials.**
- ☐ [] **Notify your current landlord/agent (if renting)** of your move-out date, respecting your required notice.

Section 3 — 1–2 Weeks Before Settlement

- ☐ [] **Organise utility connections** — electricity, gas, water, internet/NBN.
- ☐ [] **Arrange disconnection at your current address** for the day after you vacate.
- ☐ [] **Redirect your mail** via Australia Post.
- ☐ [] **Update your address** with: the electoral roll, your bank(s), employer, Medicare, insurer(s), and Access Canberra (driver's licence and vehicle registration).
- ☐ [] **Confirm final settlement figures**, including rates and owners corporation levy adjustments if applicable.
- ☐ [] **Confirm your stamp duty exemption is being correctly applied**, especially given how recently the ACT's uncapped first home buyer settings commenced (1 July 2026).

Section 4 — Settlement Week

- ☐ [] **Book your pre-settlement inspection** to confirm the property matches the agreed condition and inclusions.
- ☐ [] **Confirm final funds transfer arrangements** with your conveyancer and lender.
- ☐ [] **Confirm key collection arrangements.**
- ☐ [] **Confirm your removalist booking for the day after settlement** (or settlement day if timing allows).

Section 5 — Moving Day and Just After

- ☐ [] **Do a final walkthrough before unpacking**, photographing anything not present at your pre-settlement inspection.
- ☐ [] **Locate your fuse box, water mains shut-off, and gas shut-off** early — genuinely useful given Canberra's cold winters and the importance of functioning heating.
- ☐ [] **Set up home and contents insurance** if not already arranged.
- ☐ [] **Register relevant Access Canberra services** if not automatically transferred.
- ☐ [] **Keep all settlement paperwork** together — contract, loan documents, stamp duty exemption confirmation.

Quick Reference — Settlement Week Timeline

TIMING	KEY TASK
Signing	Confirm insurance timing, engage conveyancer
4–6 weeks out	Loan approval finalised, book removalist
1–2 weeks out	Utilities connected, mail redirected, address updates
Settlement week	Pre-settlement inspection, confirm funds transfer
Settlement day	Keys released, final walkthrough

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